$1.0 trillion

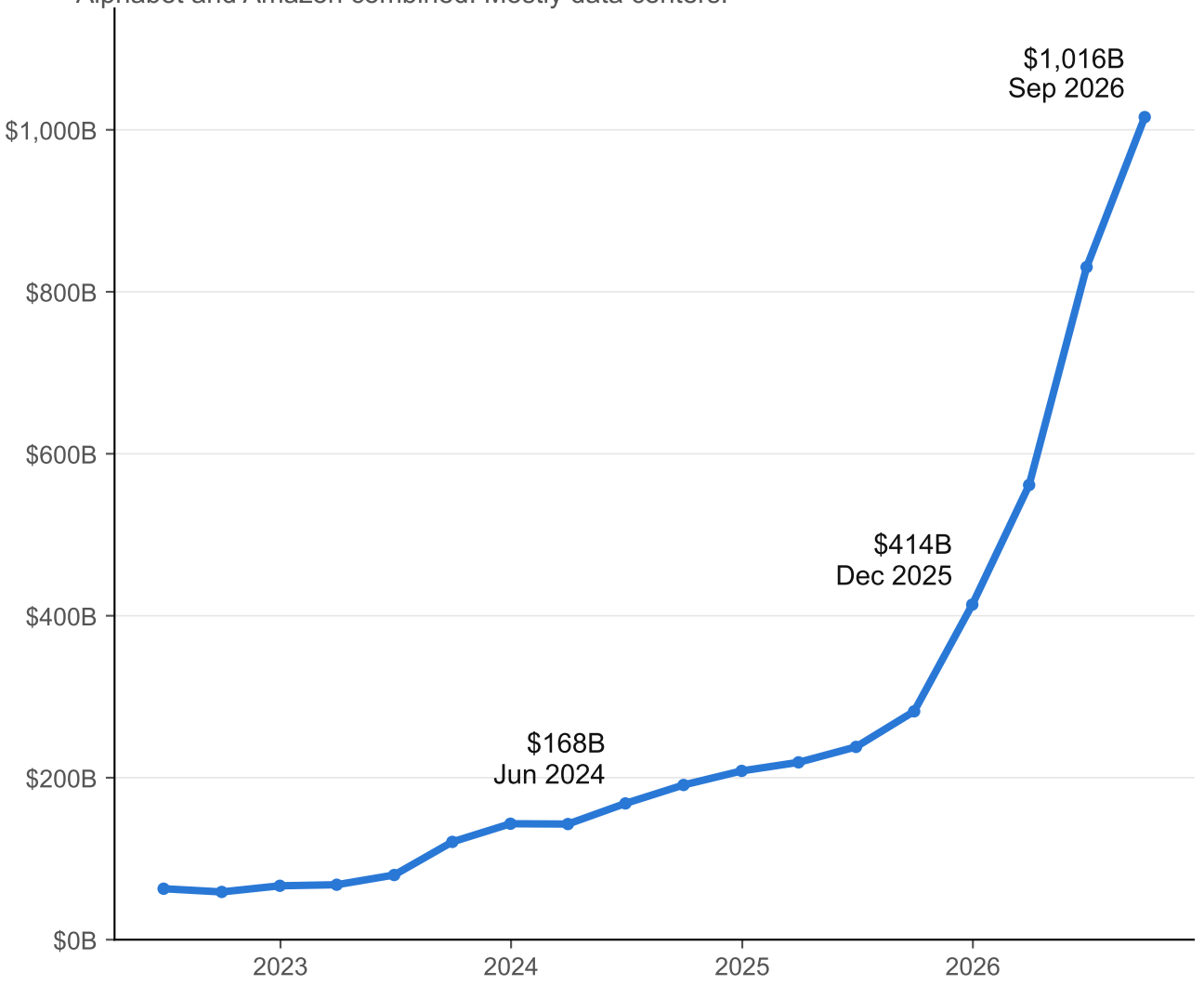
of data center leases that Microsoft, Meta, Alphabet and Amazon have signed but haven't started yet.

Two years ago it was $168 billion.

Is that demand, or a pile-up?
What 4 years of 10-Q and 10-K lease notes show.

The signed backlog went from $414B to $1T in nine months

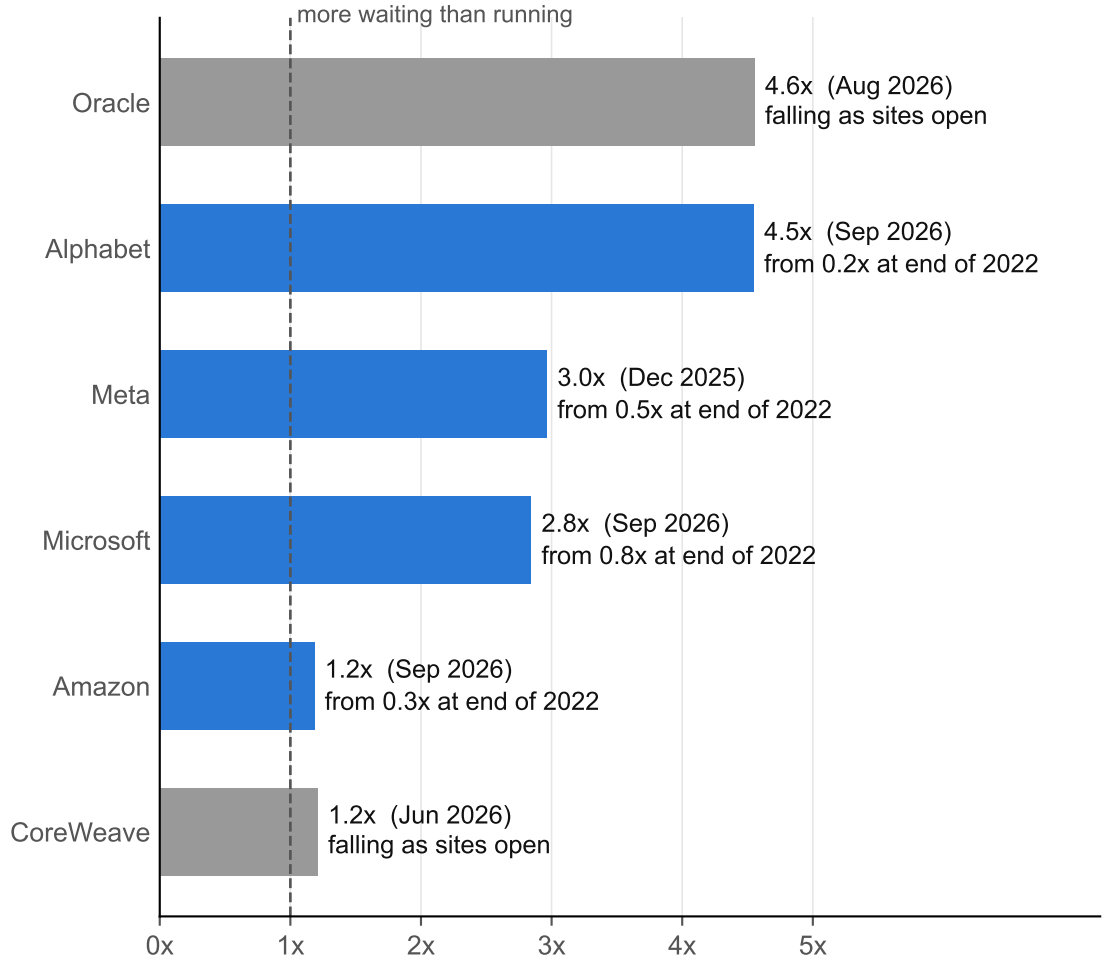
Future payments on leases signed but not started, Microsoft, Meta, Alphabet and Amazon combined. Mostly data centers.



Source: lease and commitment notes in each company's 10-Q and 10-K, 2022 to Sep 2026.
Totals over terms of up to 20 years, not one year of spending. Amazon includes warehouses.

At four of six, signed leases are piling up faster than they open

Payments on leases signed but not started, divided by payments on leases already running. Gray bars are falling.



Source: lease notes and lease maturity tables, 10-Q and 10-K. Both sides are undiscounted. Meta reports the running side only once a year. Its waiting leases have since tripled.

A few AI labs carry a lot of it

~40%

of Amazon's $578B contracted backlog comes from OpenAI and Anthropic deals

$417B

of new compute and lease commitments at Anthropic, about 9x its yearly revenue, owed "regardless of actual usage"

11%

of Microsoft's quarterly revenue came from OpenAI

72%

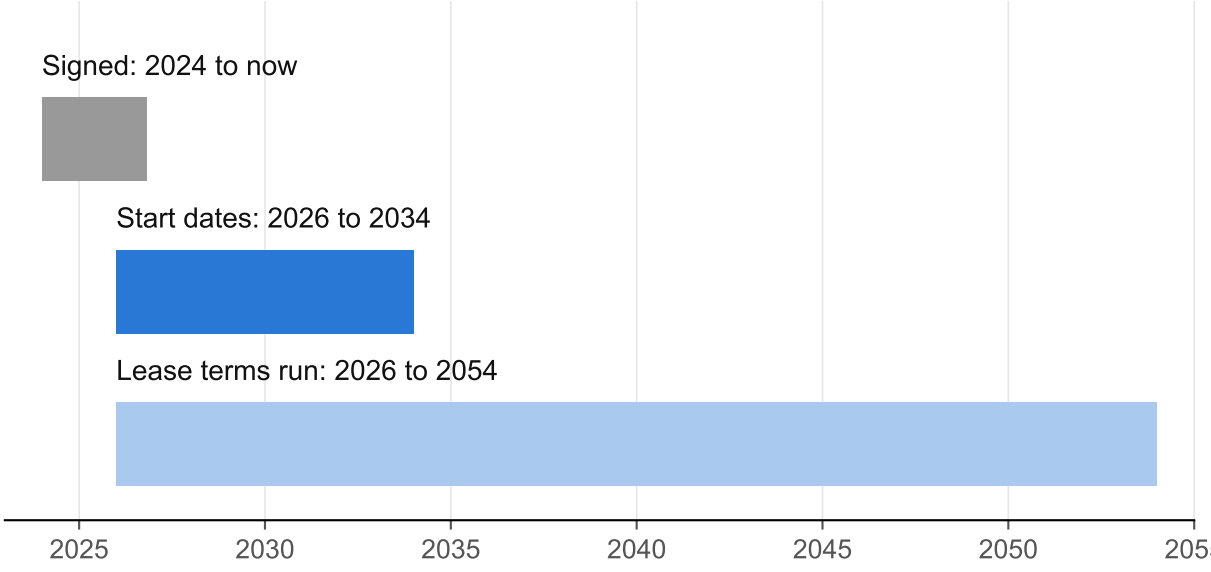
of CoreWeave's revenue came from its three largest customers

If one of them slows down, the commitments don't vanish. They become a credit problem for whoever is owed.

Sources: Amazon and Microsoft 10-Qs (Sep 2026), CoreWeave 10-Q (Jun 2026), Anthropic S-1. The 40% adds announced deal sizes against the backlog, so it's rough.

Signed on today's demand, delivered into a later market

These leases begin between 2026 and 2034 and many run 15 to 20 years. The demand case gets made once, at signing.



The market has already moved once inside this cycle.

Early 2025: Microsoft reportedly dropped about 200 MW of US leases and let over 1 GW of agreements lapse as OpenAI moved work to Oracle.

Sep 2026: Microsoft had $365B of leases signed and waiting.

Sources: lease notes (Microsoft FY2027 to FY2034, Oracle 15 to 19 year terms); TD Cowen via Bloomberg, Feb 2025. Microsoft didn't comment. Bars are ranges across companies.

What would change my mind

1 The ratio falls everywhere, the way it already has at Oracle and CoreWeave. That means buildings are opening and the backlog isn't stuck.

2 Contract GPU prices keep rising for another year. One-year H100 contracts rose about 40% from Oct 2025 to Mar 2026.

3 Texas and other grids audit their large-load requests down, and most of what's left gets built.

Demand is strong today. Northern Virginia is 0.2% vacant. That's also what the start of a build cycle looks like.

Code, data and every source:
github.com/TaborSwanson1/grid-bottleneck

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